A Treatise on the Secret Empowerment

Guhyābhiṣekaprakaraṇa · Toh 1274 · Derge Tengyur

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A Treatise on the Secret Empowerment, known in Sanskrit as the Guhyābhiṣekaprakaraṇa and in Tibetan as Sangwé Wang gi Rabtu Jepa, is a brief tantric work attributed in its colophon to the master Vīṇāpa, an Indian adept said to have attained the accomplishment of the great seal. After an homage to Vajrasattva and a verse of praise to Hevajra, it sets out, on the basis of the secret tantra, how the syllables of the Sanskrit alphabet are arranged in five groups of nine and linked with the five buddha families, and it lists the secret names, male and female, that are bestowed on disciples during the secret empowerment. It is Toh 1274 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the Indian commentaries and ritual works on the tantras, in the cycle connected with Hevajra.

In the language of India: guhya abhiṣe ka kri pa nā ma. In the language of Tibet: A Treatise on the Secret Empowerment.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

The vajra aroused by the consort (vidyā) perfects its play and enjoyment at the root;
touching each in turn, that dharma is projected upward and emanated;
emanating the projected three realms, he has come to know the immeasurable:
to Hevajra I bow with body, speech and mind.

This is explained from the secret tantra.

In the empowerment there are the four wisdoms,
fully endowed with the five signs;
they should be drawn properly and clearly.
The syllable oṃ and the syllable āṃ,
the syllable ka, joined with ca tra,
the syllable ṭa and the syllable pa,
and the letters ya and ṣa:
these are the letters of a group of nine.
The syllable o and ī are goddesses;
kha, cha, ṭha, and the fourth, another,
tha, pha and ra, śa, ya:

this is held to be the second group.
The letters ū and ū are great goddesses;
ga, ja and ḍa are joined together,
da, ba, and also la and su:
this is the third group.
Those called e and ai come first,
and then gha, jha, ḍha,
then dha, bha, va, ha as well:
this is the fourth group.
The syllable o and the syllable au,
the syllable oṃ together with the visarga,
endowed with ṇa, ña, ṇa, na and ma:
this is the lord of the group of nine.

Vajra Beauty and Vajra Striker, the four;
Sprout of Utter Delight,
Wondrous Vajra and Wisdom Vajra,
Wish-Fulfilling Vajra and Bodiless Vajra,
Wisdom Sprout and Compassion Sprout,
Vajra of Supreme Joy,
Vajra of Utter Delight,
Avalokiteśvara Vajra,
Vajra of Descent and Space Vajra,
Wisdom Vajra and Perfection Vajra,
and Passion Vajra: by these names, in a pure place, comes the accomplishment of the great seal (mahāmudrā).

The women are explained: Vajra Grace and Weapon, Vajra Emaho the Blissful One, Vajra Nairātmyā, Vajra Locanā, Vajra Ḍākinī, Vajra Gaurī, Vajra Māyā, Vajra Blazing One, Vajra Creeper, Vajra Force, Vajra Vetālī, Vajra Hook, Vajra Necklace, Vajra Garland, Vajra Smiling One, Vajra Graceful One, Vajra Lotus Stalk, Vajra Flourishing One, Vajra Lotus, Vajra Source, Vajra Laughing One, Vajra Passionate One, Vajra Tārā, Vajra Hara, Vajra Proud One, Vajra Intelligence, Vajra Konenā, Vajra Saliva, Vajra Breath and Vajra Hand.

The ḍākinīs belong to Akṣobhya. In explaining a ā ka ca ṭa ta pa ya śa, the chief, the hero, is Vairocana. i ī kha cha ṭha tha pha ra ṣa are Vajra of Utter Delight and the rest. For the jewel empowerment, u ū ga ja ḍa ba la are Wondrous Vajra and the rest. For Amitābha, ai gha jha ḍha dha bha ba ta are

Vajra Lotus Sprout and the rest. For Amoghasiddhi, o au aṃ āḥ ṅa ña ṇa na ma are Vajra Avalokiteśvara and the rest.

The Treatise on the Names of the Secret Empowerment, The Correct Instruction Hard to Unravel, is complete. It was composed by the master Vīṇāpa, who possessed the accomplishment of the great seal.

Translator's Notes

• The secret names conferred in the empowerment are descriptive and are translated by meaning; Sanskrit originals for most cannot be identified with confidence (for example, "Vajra Lotus Stalk" for pad rkan ma and "Vajra Konenā" for ko ne na ma, whose sense is unclear). In the closing correspondences the text pairs the letter groups with Akṣobhya, Vairocana, a "jewel empowerment" (presumably Ratnasambhava), Amitābha and Amoghasiddhi somewhat loosely; I have rendered it as it stands. Snang ba mtha' yas is rendered Amitābha.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.